

Teaching Statement

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Teaching is most fulfilling when a student who was stuck begins to see why an economic outcome occurs. To help students make that shift, I want them to use economic models not simply to solve equations, but to distinguish an observed pattern from the mechanism that produces it. For example, when a new restaurant opens on campus, students may treat a long line as evidence that the food is good. However, the line is only a signal. As more people observe it and join, the line can keep growing even when the food is bad. Thus, this familiar example gives students a way into herding under imperfect information. A different example comes from asking why a government might issue consumption vouchers instead of cash. Because vouchers must be spent, more of the transfer enters current demand and the multiplier is larger. These examples shape how I teach. I begin with the economic intuition and introduce the formula only after students understand the question it answers. Once the intuition is clear, I ask students to work through the reasoning and tell me where it stops being clear. When one student asks a question, it often helps several others and shows me where I need to explain an idea more simply. For me, finding that clearer explanation is the part of teaching I enjoy most.

My teaching experience at the Hong Kong University of Science and Technology has taught me how to put this approach into practice. From 2020 to 2025, I served as a teaching assistant for undergraduate macroeconomics, industrial organization, and the economics of uncertainty and information. Across these courses, I led weekly tutorials, held office hours, and graded. Through tutorials and office hours, I learned to identify where a student's reasoning became unclear and rebuild the argument from that point. At the doctoral level, I primarily led tutorials and answered questions for PhD microeconomic theory, which is taken by doctoral students across the Business School. In this course, I often approached the same question in several ways until the idea became clear. My evaluations provide one measure of this work. On a scale where 4 means good and 5 means extremely satisfied, my average across these teaching assistant appointments was 4.48. My two evaluations for PhD microeconomic theory were 4.85 and 4.83. In addition, I lectured in the mathematics camp for the MSc in Economics in 2026. Because most participants did not have the mathematical background assumed by the program, I developed the intuition and notation step by step. My teaching received a score of 4.5 out of 5, and student comments included "Very nice and patient!" and "Excellent teaching." Alongside my classroom teaching, I served as Teaching Assistant Coordinator for the Business School from 2025 to 2026. In that role, I helped postgraduate students design teaching materials, evaluated their mock teaching, and discussed where students

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might lose the thread and how those steps could be explained more clearly.

As the instructor of my own courses, I would keep the same emphasis on intuition, active reasoning, and clear explanation. I am prepared to teach microeconomic theory at the undergraduate, master's, and PhD levels. Beyond microeconomic theory, I can teach industrial organization, information economics, structural estimation, and mathematics for economists through the master's level. At the undergraduate level, I can also teach empirical industrial organization, macroeconomics, and econometrics. I would also like to help students use AI responsibly in research projects. Since AI can produce confident but incorrect output when a task has not been defined carefully, students should first state the problem and decide what evidence will show that the task is complete. After that, I would teach them practical habits for managing the work. These include reporting their progress, maintaining readable code in R or Python, and using Git to track versions. Together, these habits help students catch mistakes and verify work produced with AI.